

AstroMenace

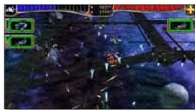
Genre: Arcade

Game play

AstroMenace is a brilliant 3D scroll-shooter that asks you to guide a spaceship, and destroy enemy ships and alien invaders in a fierce space battle. What makes it most interesting is the option of upgrading spaceships, advanced weaponry, missiles and armour. It also comes with pilot profiles so that your younger brother doesn't start fragging the aliens and skew your streak! And yes, AstroMenace definitely reminds us of Tyrian, a lot.

Video

The 3D graphics are a treat for any seasoned arcade player. The various kinds of ammunition and



spaceships have been designed very well and the brilliant rendering makes the gaming experience a great one.

Audio

Nothing ground-breaking; but neither is it too boring, as is normally the case with such scroll-shooter games.

Download URL: <http://www.viewizard.com/download.php>



Just a few more words...

So, as is evident, LLGN has done a great job in compiling the games for us to review. I say 'review' because, being a live DVD, you will not be able to save the game data for the future. What that means is, if today you finish the first 7 levels of a game and then plan to continue it tomorrow, the very moment you reboot, all that data gets lost and you end up playing the same levels all over again. Moreover, there will be a lot of games that simply refuse to run on Intel graphics. So serious was the issue that we actually had to find a specific NVIDIA machine to test drive all the games.

The DVD comes with a very basic installation of Arch Linux, with IceWM as the desktop environment. It comes preloaded with Gran Paradiso (a nightly build of Mozilla Firefox 3.0.11), the terminal and a network manager. While the distro detected our wireless cards seamlessly, if it doesn't do the same for you, a LAN card should come to your rescue.

Summing it up, while the collection of games is really addictive and fun, open source games are still aeons away from the professional games that get developed for the Windows and Macintosh platforms. Personally, I feel it is the community's fetish for open source games that doesn't lure the game publishers to give the Linux platform a serious look. While it might be more of an economic aspect, LLGN helps us show the world that Linux, as a platform, is as suited for gaming as anything else, if not better! **END** 

By: Sayantan Pal

An avid Twitter user and a social media enthusiast, the author is a passionate blogger and a professional gamer too. He also feels compelled to be opinionated about anything that comes his way, be it Linux distributions, our marketing strategies, table etiquettes or even the fabled Ramsay movies!

Mania Drive

Genre: Arcade

Game play

This car game is extremely addictive and frustrating at the same time. The idea of the game is to challenge the player against a variety of tracks that have really sharp turns, jumps and 360-degree hoops. On the whole, the game play is very smooth and reminds me a lot of one of the most popular games in this genre, Track Mania.

However, the tracks are few and once they are done, the only fun left would be to directly

pit yourself against human opponents, online. What makes it more challenging is that you've got to finish every single track within 'gold' time, else you lose. No mercy at all!

Video

While the background is too bland and so is the car, they do not dampen the spirit of the game even a single bit.

Audio

Mania Drive features eight songs that are all licensed under the Creative Commons and can therefore be freely distributed within the game. Most of the ogg-files can be categorised as rock music and that perfectly fits the fast, dynamic game play.

Download URL: <http://mania-drive.raydium.org/index.php?downloads=yes>

